The Coopers of Redcliff Back

Introduction

A merchant of Bristol who lost a ship in the autumn might find that his factors in Waterford had already drawn upon him for the whole of the spring crop. Freight rates moved with the season and with the news from Europe, and a rumour of war could double the cost of a voyage within a week. Letters took from five to eight weeks to cross the Atlantic, so that every decision was made on information that was already out of date. Insurance was dear, and the underwriters of the Exchange coffee house were slow to pay a claim that touched upon the capture of a vessel. Historians have long debated how far the Bristol houses depended upon the Jamaica planters, and how far the planters upon them.

The volume of trade can be estimated from the duties paid, though the figures need to be read with care, since cargoes were often entered at a round number. The Hotwells yards, a short distance below the city, were able to build for owners from Bristol, Liverpool and London alike. Historians have long debated how far the Bristol houses depended upon the Jamaica planters, and how far the planters upon them. Letters took from five to eight weeks to cross the Atlantic, so that every decision was made on information that was already out of date.

Some of the most revealing documents in the collection are the least formal: a note about a wet cargo, or a list of things to be bought for a ship. The chapter that follows rests chiefly upon the letters of the years 1783 to 1790, which are the most complete in the collection. The Hotwells yards, a short distance below the city, were able to build for owners from Bristol, Liverpool and London alike. The cooper's trade was as important as the shipwright's, for a cask that leaked was a cargo lost, and the cost fell on the owner.

Letters took from five to eight weeks to cross the Atlantic, so that every decision was made on information that was already out of date. The correspondence shows a house that was careful rather than bold, and which seldom put more than a third of its capital into any one voyage. The cooper's trade was as important as the shipwright's, for a cask that leaked was a cargo lost, and the cost fell on the owner. Insurance was dear, and the underwriters of the Exchange coffee house were slow to pay a claim that touched upon the capture of a vessel. The Hotwells yards, a short distance below the city, were able to build for owners from Bristol, Liverpool and London alike. No account of the trade can ignore the part played by the factors, who stood between the planter and the merchant and took a commission from both.

Staves and hoops

Your account of the staves is noted, but the sample you sent was very fair, and I would not take more than 37 bales on those terms. The clerk has copied the bill of lading twice, as Mrs. Dunning would not accept the first for the want of a seal. I enclose the account of sales of the salt beef, from which you will see that the net proceeds were £480 18s after all charges. I cannot tell you how the mahogany will sell until the autumn fleet is in, for the grocers of Dublin are buying from hand to mouth. Your account of the ginger is noted, but the sample you sent was sound, and I would not take more than 67 tons on those terms.

I have seen Messrs. Lyle & Pountney at the Exchange, and payment for the rum is promised before autumn. I cannot tell you how the salt beef will sell until the Michaelmas fleet is in, for the grocers of Gloucester are buying from hand to mouth. The clerk has copied the bill of lading twice, as Mrs. Anstey would not accept the first for the want of a seal. We have drawn on you at sixty days for £730 18s, which I beg you will honour, and charge the same to the cargo of the Amity.

The clerk has copied the bill of lading twice, as Mr. Alleyne would not accept the first for the want of a seal. The price of ginger in the Bristol market stood at £32 10s 5d the hundredweight when the Betsey came up the Avon, and I doubt it will hold. The warehouse in Queen Square is full of pimento, and until the Union is cleared I cannot receive any more. Be so good as to send by the next conveyance a statement of what stands to our credit with Mr. Withers, for the half-yearly balance is close at hand. I have seen Mr. Withers at the Exchange, and payment for the rum is promised before winter.

The warehouse in Queen Square is full of pimento, and until the Providence is cleared I cannot receive any more. The warehouse in Queen Square is full of muscovado sugar, and until the Hester is cleared I cannot receive any more. The price of cotton in the Bristol market stood at £51 17s 5d the hundredweight when the Betsey came up the Avon, and I doubt it will hold. The price of pimento in the Bristol market stood at £35 13s 4d the hundredweight when the Amity came up the Avon, and I doubt it will hold. The price of logwood in the Bristol market stood at £34 17s 5d the hundredweight when the Betsey came up the Avon, and I doubt it will hold.

I enclose the account of sales of the indigo, from which you will see that the net proceeds were £196 14s after all charges. The warehouse in Queen Square is full of cordage, and until the Industry is cleared I cannot receive any more. Freight to Kingston is now £7 5s the ton, and the underwriters at the Exchange ask twelve per cent for the voyage. I have seen Mr. Withers at the Exchange, and payment for the linen is promised before Christmas. If the cordage is damp on arrival we shall claim upon the underwriters, and I beg you to have a surveyor's certificate ready.

I enclose the account of sales of the cordage, from which you will see that the net proceeds were £104 11s after all charges. The wharfinger asks £17 11s 9d for the landing of the muscovado sugar, which I think too much, and I have told him so. A letter from Capt. Lyle at Glasgow says that hoops will be taken only at a discount of seven per cent, which I have declined. Be so good as to send by the next conveyance a statement of what stands to our credit with Mrs. Dunning, for the half-yearly balance is close at hand. Be so good as to send by the next conveyance a statement of what stands to our credit with Capt. Lyle, for the half-yearly balance is close at hand.

I enclose the account of sales of the cotton, from which you will see that the net proceeds were £758 16s after all charges. The warehouse in Queen Square is full of hoops, and until the Charming Sally is cleared I cannot receive any more. We have drawn on you at sixty days for £237 3s, which I beg you will honour, and charge the same to the cargo of the Mary Ann. A letter from Mr. Withers at Bath says that ginger will be taken only at a discount of ten per cent, which I have declined.

The trade at home and abroad

The correspondence shows a house that was careful rather than bold, and which seldom put more than a third of its capital into any one voyage. Freight rates moved with the season and with the news from Europe, and a rumour of war could double the cost of a voyage within a week. The volume of trade can be estimated from the duties paid, though the figures need to be read with care, since cargoes were often entered at a round number. Freight rates moved with the season and with the news from Europe, and a rumour of war could double the cost of a voyage within a week.

The reader who comes to these papers expecting the great questions of the age will find instead a very close attention to casks, hoops and freight. Letters took from five to eight weeks to cross the Atlantic, so that every decision was made on information that was already out of date. The sugar trade of the eighteenth century rested upon credit, and credit rested upon the character of the man who gave it. The volume of trade can be estimated from the duties paid, though the figures need to be read with care, since cargoes were often entered at a round number. Some of the most revealing documents in the collection are the least formal: a note about a wet cargo, or a list of things to be bought for a ship.

The sugar trade of the eighteenth century rested upon credit, and credit rested upon the character of the man who gave it. The volume of trade can be estimated from the duties paid, though the figures need to be read with care, since cargoes were often entered at a round number. A ship's master was at once a navigator, a trader and a disciplinarian, and the owners trusted him with a good deal more than the sailing of the vessel. The volume of trade can be estimated from the duties paid, though the figures need to be read with care, since cargoes were often entered at a round number.

The river Avon, with its great tidal range, shaped the working day of every merchant in the city; ships could move only at the top of the tide. The river Avon, with its great tidal range, shaped the working day of every merchant in the city; ships could move only at the top of the tide. A ship's master was at once a navigator, a trader and a disciplinarian, and the owners trusted him with a good deal more than the sailing of the vessel. The reader who comes to these papers expecting the great questions of the age will find instead a very close attention to casks, hoops and freight.

Some of the most revealing documents in the collection are the least formal: a note about a wet cargo, or a list of things to be bought for a ship. Freight rates moved with the season and with the news from Europe, and a rumour of war could double the cost of a voyage within a week. The Hotwells yards, a short distance below the city, were able to build for owners from Bristol, Liverpool and London alike. The correspondence shows a house that was careful rather than bold, and which seldom put more than a third of its capital into any one voyage.

Historians have long debated how far the Bristol houses depended upon the Jamaica planters, and how far the planters upon them. The sugar trade of the eighteenth century rested upon credit, and credit rested upon the character of the man who gave it. The correspondence shows a house that was careful rather than bold, and which seldom put more than a third of its capital into any one voyage. The correspondence shows a house that was careful rather than bold, and which seldom put more than a third of its capital into any one voyage. The reader who comes to these papers expecting the great questions of the age will find instead a very close attention to casks, hoops and freight.

The cooper's trade was as important as the shipwright's, for a cask that leaked was a cargo lost, and the cost fell on the owner. It is the small entries, the cost of a boat or the loan of a lantern, that tell us most about the daily life of the quay. The reader who comes to these papers expecting the great questions of the age will find instead a very close attention to casks, hoops and freight. The firm's books were kept in the Italian manner, but the clerks of the period were not always consistent in their treatment of the discount. The firm's books were kept in the Italian manner, but the clerks of the period were not always consistent in their treatment of the discount. The reader who comes to these papers expecting the great questions of the age will find instead a very close attention to casks, hoops and freight.

Conclusion

It is the small entries, the cost of a boat or the loan of a lantern, that tell us most about the daily life of the quay. No account of the trade can ignore the part played by the factors, who stood between the planter and the merchant and took a commission from both. Seen from the counting house, the abolition debates of the period were at first a distant noise, and only later a matter of direct concern. The correspondence shows a house that was careful rather than bold, and which seldom put more than a third of its capital into any one voyage. Seen from the counting house, the abolition debates of the period were at first a distant noise, and only later a matter of direct concern.

The chapter that follows rests chiefly upon the letters of the years 1783 to 1790, which are the most complete in the collection. Freight rates moved with the season and with the news from Europe, and a rumour of war could double the cost of a voyage within a week. A merchant of Bristol who lost a ship in the autumn might find that his factors in Montego Bay had already drawn upon him for the whole of the spring crop. The firm's books were kept in the Italian manner, but the clerks of the period were not always consistent in their treatment of the discount.

The Hotwells yards, a short distance below the city, were able to build for owners from Bristol, Liverpool and London alike. The chapter that follows rests chiefly upon the letters of the years 1783 to 1790, which are the most complete in the collection. The Hotwells yards, a short distance below the city, were able to build for owners from Bristol, Liverpool and London alike.